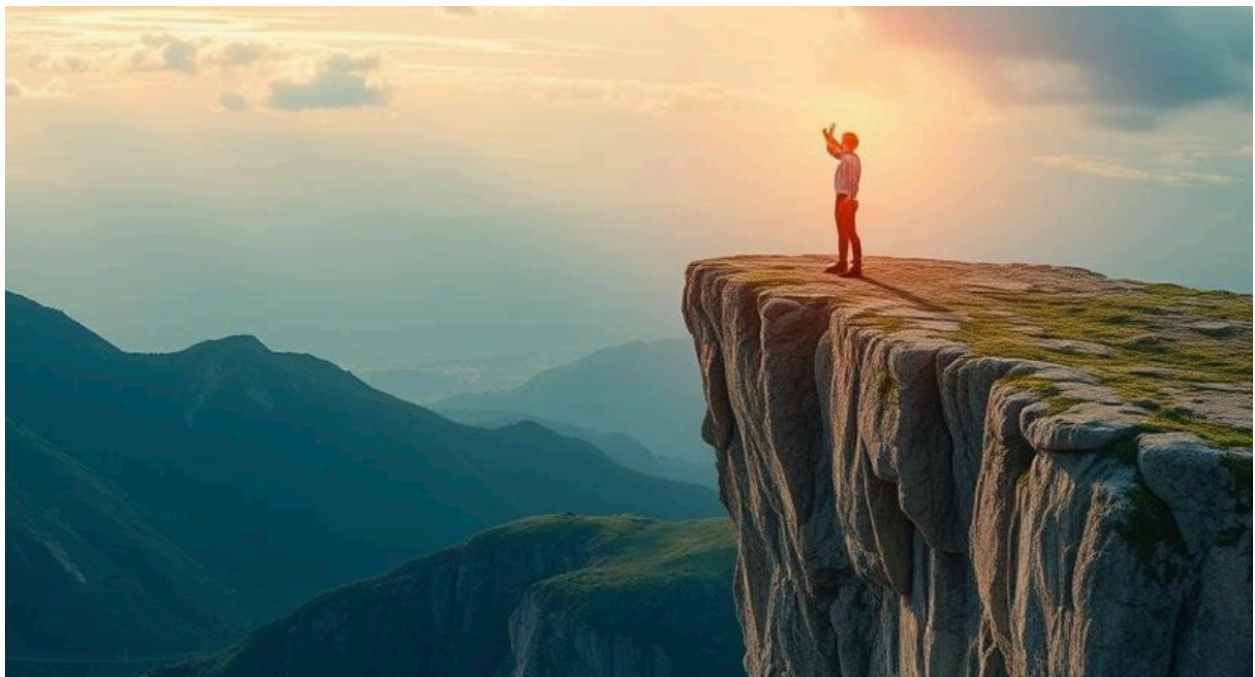


13/06/2025

Verge, Dwindling, Contemporary, Embracing, Hunkered

1. Verge (किनारा / सीमांत) (*Noun / Verb*) (*verj*) (*Neutral tone*)

- **Meaning (English):** The edge or border of something; the point at which something is about to happen.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** किसी चीज़ का किनारा या ऐसी स्थिति जब कुछ होने ही वाला हो।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Latin *vergere* → **Old French *verge*** (“rod, stick”) → Middle English *verge* (boundary)
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** brink, threshold, cusp
 - **Antonyms:** center, middle, core
- **Connotation:** Often used to express being close to a transition—positive or negative.
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A person standing at the edge of a cliff, about to jump into a new opportunity.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (100 words):**

The climate crisis has brought the world to the verge of irreversible damage. Many researchers argue that unless urgent action is taken, rising temperatures, sea levels, and extreme weather will lead to mass displacement. Policy reforms, international cooperation, and sustainable innovation are the only ways to pull societies back from the verge. Meanwhile, public awareness continues to grow, driven by education, media, and activism.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- ❌ *He was in the verge of tears.* (वह आँसूओं के किनारे था।)
- ✅ *He was on the verge of tears.* (वह रोने ही वाला था।)

- **Example + Grammar Explanation:**

- ✅ *The company is on the verge of collapse.* (कंपनी पतन के कगार पर है।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - **S (Subject):** *The company*
 - **V (Verb – Linking Verb):** *is*
 - **O (Object):** — (None; linking verb connects to complement)
 - **+ (Complement – Prepositional Phrase):** *on the verge of collapse*
 - ↳ “**verge**” = noun
 - ↳ “**of collapse**” = prepositional modifier describing the kind of verge

- **Common Collocations:**

- on the verge of, verge between, verge towards

- **My Statement:**

- **(NOUN)**
 - She is on the verge of getting blacklisted by various organizations due to her misleading work.
 - I am standing at the verge towards prosperity, just have to work rationally every single time. ***
 - I am standing on the verge of prosperity; I just have to work rationally every single time.
 - The economy is on the verge of recession.
- **(VERB)**
 - She verged on accountability at his organization. ***

- Her actions verged on negligence, prompting concerns about accountability within the organization.
- He was verging on enlightenment after measuring everything that was possible about himself.
- He was verged on jeopardising himself by not taking proper care. ***
- By ignoring his health, he verged on jeopardizing his future.

- **My Notes:**

- **V1 to V5 (Verge)**

- V1: They often verge on impatience during meetings.
 - V2: The conversation verged on being inappropriate.
 - V3: His behavior had verged on rudeness.
 - V4: She is verging on burnout due to overwork.
 - V5: He verges on panic every time there's a delay.

2. Dwindling (घटता हुआ / कम होता हुआ) (*Adjective / Verb - Gerund*) (*dwin-dl-ing*) (*Negative tone*)

- **Meaning (English):** Gradually becoming smaller or less.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** धीरे-धीरे घटता हुआ या कम होता हुआ।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Scandinavian root → **Old Norse *dvergr* (to shrink)** → English *dwindle*
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** decreasing, shrinking, reducing
 - **Antonyms:** growing, increasing, expanding
- **Connotation:** Negative—often used for resources, populations, influence.
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A candle burning down to a stub, representing fading strength.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (100 words):**

The dwindling water supply in semi-arid regions has become a pressing concern. Overuse, mismanagement, and climate change have accelerated this decline. Villages now receive water only once a week. Dwindling groundwater levels are forcing farmers to abandon their lands. Experts advocate for micro-irrigation and watershed management to reverse this trend.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- ❌ *The dwindling are forest.* (कम हो रहे हैं जंगल।)
- ✅ *The forests are dwindling rapidly.* (जंगल तेजी से घट रहे हैं।)

- **Example + Grammar Explanation:**

- ✅ *Their hopes were dwindling with each passing day.* (उनकी उम्मीदें हर गुजरते दिन के साथ क्षीण होती जा रही थीं।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - **S (Subject):** Their hopes
 - **V (Verb – Past Progressive):** were dwindling
 - **O (Object):** — (None; "dwindle" is intransitive)
 - **+ (Modifier – Adverbial Phrase of Time):** with each passing day

- **Common Collocations:**

- dwindling population, dwindling resources, dwindling hopes

- **My Statement:**

- **(ADJECTIVE)**

- The dwindling population of the village due to migration was a concern for many people.
- In the Antarctic, the dwindling icebergs were a sign of global warming. ***
- In the Antarctic, the dwindling ice sheets were a sign of global warming.
- The dwindling mancount in the site slowed down the overall development process. ***
- The dwindling manpower at the site slowed down the overall development process.

- **(VERB)**

- Dwindling of underground water resources is due to excessive utilization and reconstruction at spot which could help replenish these resources. ***
- The dwindling of underground water resources is due to excessive utilization and a lack of reconstruction at sites that could help replenish these resources.
- The dwindling of the workforce is common in countries where more people are getting aged than juniors entering the workforce. ***

- The dwindling of the workforce is common in countries where more people are aging than the number of young individuals entering the workforce.
- The dwindling of certain birds in an area already tells about climatic changes. ***
- The dwindling of certain bird species in the area already indicates climatic changes.

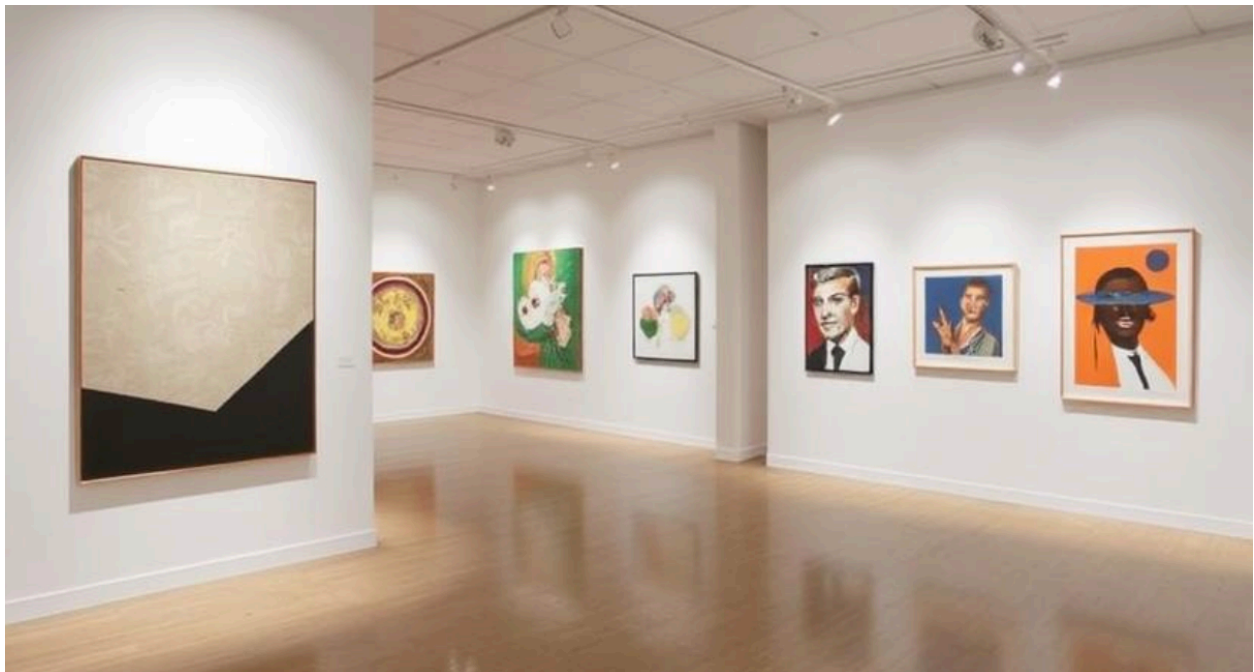
- **My Notes:**

- **Icebergs vs. Ice Sheets**

- Scientifically, “icebergs” are floating ice masses that naturally break off (calve) and melt.
- “Ice sheets” or “sea ice” are more accurate terms when referring to climate change effects.
- If you mean large ice masses on land or sea, “ice sheets” is a better fit.

3. Contemporary (समकालीन) (*Adjective / Noun*) (*kuhn-tem-puh-rer-ee*) (*Neutral to Positive tone*)

- **Meaning (English):** Belonging to the present time; living or occurring at the same time.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** जो वर्तमान समय में हो या एक ही समय में मौजूद हो।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Latin *con-* (together) + *temporarius* (of time) → **contemporarius** → English
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** modern, present-day, current
 - **Antonyms:** ancient, outdated, archaic
- **Connotation:** Positive when referring to modern relevance.
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A modern art gallery showcasing works by current artists.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (100 words):**

Contemporary architecture embraces minimalism, sustainability, and integration with the environment. Unlike classical or postmodern styles, contemporary design often uses open spaces, glass, and eco-friendly materials. Architects emphasize function over ornate detailing, prioritizing the human experience inside the space. This approach also aligns with evolving values such as climate responsibility and urban adaptability.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- ❌ *This idea is very contemporary old.* (यह विचार समकालीन पुराना है।)
- ✅ *This is a highly contemporary concept.* (यह एक अत्यधिक समकालीन विचार है।)

- **Example + Grammar Explanation:**

- ✅ *Her work blends contemporary and classical elements.* (उसका काम समकालीन और शास्त्रीय तत्वों का मेल है।)

- **Grammar Breakdown:**

- **S (Subject):** Her work
- **V (Verb):** blends
- **O (Object):** contemporary and classical elements

- **Common Collocations:**

- contemporary art, contemporary society, contemporary issues

- **My Statement:**

- **(NOUN)**

- He was contemporary to Adolf Hitler at that time. ***
- He was a contemporary of Adolf Hitler at that time.
- My contemporaries know about me very well.
- She was hesitant to talk about her contemporaries at the office.

- **(ADJECTIVE)**

- Contemporary art was merged with ancient art to create a unique blend.
- Our bad contemporary memories may fade away over time but some of the remnants will stay with us forever. ***
- Our unpleasant contemporary memories may fade over time, but some remnants will stay with us forever.
- We need to resolve contemporary issues as soon as possible.

- **My Notes:**

- **Contemporary (Noun):**

- "Contemporary" is primarily used as an adjective, it can also function as a noun, usually meaning a person living at the same time as another or someone of the same age or era.

■ **Examples (with Explanation):**

- **He was a contemporary of Einstein.** (वह आइंस्टीन का समकालीन था।)
- ✓ "Contemporary" refers to a person who lived during the same period as Einstein.
- **Shakespeare's contemporaries also contributed greatly to literature.** (शेक्सपियर के समकालीनों ने भी साहित्य में बड़ा योगदान दिया।)
- ✓ Here, "contemporaries" means other writers living during Shakespeare's era.
- **Unlike his contemporaries, he preferred realism over romanticism.** (अपने समकालीनों के विपरीत, वह रोमांटिकता की बजाय यथार्थवाद को पसंद करता था।)
- ✓ Compare someone to people of his time.
- **Many of her contemporaries have already retired.** (उसके कई समकालीन पहले ही सेवानिवृत्त हो चुके हैं।)
- ✓ Refers to people of the same age or professional period.

4. Embracing (अपनाना / गले लगाना) (Verb - Gerund / Adjective) (em-bray-sing) (Positive tone)

- **Meaning (English):** Accepting or welcoming something openly or enthusiastically.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** किसी विचार, परिवर्तन या व्यक्ति को खुले दिल से अपनाना।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Latin *bracchium* (arm) → **Old French *embracer* (to clasp in arms)** → English
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** adopting, welcoming, accepting
 - **Antonyms:** rejecting, resisting, avoiding
- **Connotation:** Positive — implies openness, warmth, or progressiveness.
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A person opening their arms to a rising sun, symbolizing hope and acceptance.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (100 words):**

Organizations are increasingly embracing digital transformation. From automating workflows to leveraging data analytics, companies understand that embracing technology is no longer optional. This shift not only improves efficiency but also meets customer expectations. Embracing change requires investment in upskilling, flexible

culture, and a long-term vision. Resistance to this transformation could lead to stagnation.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- ❌ *He is embracing to the new rules.* (वह नए नियमों को अपनाने को है।)
- ✅ *He is embracing the new rules.* (वह नए नियमों को अपना रहा है।)

- **Example + Grammar Explanation:**

- ✅ *By embracing innovation, the company gained a competitive edge.* (नवाचार को अपनाकर कंपनी ने प्रतिस्पर्धात्मक बढ़त हासिल की।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - **S (Subject):** the company
 - **V (Verb):** gained
 - **O (Object):** a competitive edge
 - **+ (Modifier - Introductory Phrase):** by embracing innovation
 - ↳ **Gerund phrase** acting as an adverbial modifier (explains **how** the action was done)

- **Common Collocations:**

- embracing diversity, embracing change, embracing technology

- **My Statement:**

- **(ADJECTIVE)**
 - The embracing technology showed greater results than expected. ***
 - The embracing technology of smart automation showed greater results than expected.
 - Embracing changes help us to gain more profits than our contemporaries. ***
 - Embracing change helps us gain more profits than our contemporaries.
 - The embracing methods of a better economy help strengthen a newer economy to flourish. ***
 - The embracing methods of a reform-oriented economy help strengthen emerging financial systems.

- **(GERUND)**

- By embracing modern workflows, we are not only just reducing our workload but also gaining more time to invest in other areas. ***
- By embracing modern workflows, we are not only reducing our workload but also gaining more time to invest in other areas.
- By embracing rapid changes at our organization, we can safeguard us from market uncertainty. ***
- By embracing rapid changes in our organization, we can safeguard ourselves from market uncertainty.
- Embracing diversity in our organization to a small percentage would be suffice for now. ***
- Embracing diversity in our organization to a small extent would suffice for now.

- **My Notes:**

- **General Note:**

- "Embracing" is not commonly used as a standalone adjective. It's typically a present participle or gerund used in progressive verbs or noun phrases, not as a direct modifier like "embracing technology."
- To use it adjectivally, it must clearly describe a subject that is embracing.
- **Statement Clarification (related to adjective):**
 - **The embracing technology of smart automation showed greater results than expected.**
 - ("embracing" as an adjective (i.e., a present participle acting adjectivally to describe a noun))
 - **Explanation:** "Embracing" is used as a **present participle adjective**, describing technology that is actively incorporating or adopting something — in this case, smart automation.

5. Hunkered (झुक कर बैठना / डटा रहना) (Verb - Past / Adjective) (huhn-kurd) (Neutral to Resilient tone)

- **Meaning (English):** To crouch down low; to stay in a position firmly or patiently.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** नीचे झुककर बैठना या डटे रहना, विशेषकर कठिन समय में।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Scottish *hunker* (crouch) → **dialectal use** → expanded into figurative English
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonyms:** crouched, squatted, persevered
 - **Antonyms:** stood, surrendered, abandoned
- **Connotation:** Neutral to positive — often used for strategic patience or survival.
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A soldier hunkered down in a trench, waiting for the storm to pass.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (100 words):**

As the storm intensified, villagers hunkered in their homes with minimal supplies. Emergency warnings had prompted precautionary measures, but no one anticipated the scale of destruction. Some families hunkered together in community centers, waiting for rescue. The term “hunkered” captures not just physical positioning, but emotional endurance — staying grounded through adversity.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage (English + Hindi Equivalent):**

- ❌ *We hunkered to the place for safety.* (हम वहाँ सुरक्षा के लिए झुके।)
- ✅ *We hunkered down at the place for safety.* (हम सुरक्षा के लिए वहाँ झुक कर बैठे।)

- **Example + Grammar Explanation:**

- ✅ *They hunkered down until the danger passed.* (उन्होंने तब तक डटे रहकर स्थिति का सामना किया जब तक खतरा टल नहीं गया।)

- **Grammar Breakdown:**

- **S (Subject):** They
- **V (Verb – Phrasal, Intransitive):** hunkered down
- **O (Object):** — (None; verb is intransitive)
- **+ (Adverbial Clause of Time):** until the danger passed
 - ↳ **S:** the danger
 - ↳ **V:** passed

- **Common Collocations:**

- hunkered down, hunkered together, hunkered inside

- **My Statement:**

- **(ADJECTIVE)**

- The hunkered individual may stay stagnant in his life until suitable changes are made. ***
- The hunkered-down individual may remain stagnant in life until suitable changes are made.
- He always had a hunkered personality, nobody really admired him. ***
- He always had a hunkered-down attitude, which made it hard for others to admire him.
- How can you always stay hunkered down as if you were the culprit? ***
- How can you always stay hunkered down as if you're the culprit?

- **(VERB)**

- We hunkered down until the mob exited the place.
- We often hunker when we feel extremely low in our life. ***
- We often hunker down when we feel extremely low in life.

- We tend to hunker down when we see trouble coming into our way. ***
- We tend to hunker down when we see trouble coming our way.

- **My Notes:**

- "Hunker down" is often used metaphorically for bracing oneself, lying low, or enduring difficulty.
- "Hunkered" as an adjective works more naturally in the form "hunkered-down", describing someone who is mentally or emotionally withdrawn, guarded, or defensive.